

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Microsoft Sentinel / SIEM Engineer | KQL | Detection Engineering | Multi-Cloud Log Ingestion

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) and Senior Security Engineer with over five years of enterprise-level experience building and operating Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) environments at scale. I specialise in enterprise-wide log onboarding across hybrid and multi-cloud environments, deploying standard and custom connectors, Function Apps, and parsers to build tailored SIEM solutions. I have strong Kusto Query Language (KQL) skills, with hands-on experience authoring and deploying analytics rules, detection workbooks, and hunting queries. I partner closely with incident response (IR) teams on live security events, tuning detection rules against real-world threat actor activity and building Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks to automate alert enrichment and response. I bring deep expertise across Microsoft Defender XDR (Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Microsoft Defender for Identity, and Microsoft Defender for M365), CrowdStrike Falcon, and Microsoft Entra ID, enabling me to parse and normalise log telemetry from identity, endpoint, cloud, and network layers with precision and cost awareness.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel:** Enterprise-wide log onboarding, custom connectors, Function Apps, parsers, analytics rules, KQL workbooks, SOAR playbooks
- **KQL (Kusto Query Language):** Detection rule authoring, threat hunting queries, workbook development, investigation automation
- **SIEM Content Development:** Analytics rules, detection engineering, MITRE ATT&CK coverage mapping, use-case design
- **Log Ingestion and Telemetry:** Hybrid and multi-cloud log ingestion pipelines, log parsing, normalisation, telemetry optimisation for cost and precision
- **Microsoft Defender XDR:** Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), Defender for M365, XDR signal integration into Sentinel
- **Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory):** Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), identity telemetry
- **SOAR Automation:** Azure Logic Apps, playbook development, alert enrichment, automated triage and response workflows
- **CrowdStrike Falcon:** NG-SIEM, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Prevent, Insight, Discover - log integration with Sentinel
- **Scripting:** PowerShell, Python, KQL; Azure CLI for investigation and automation
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 lifecycle, IR team partnership, post-incident reviews, root-cause analysis
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Own and optimise enterprise-wide log onboarding into Microsoft Sentinel, deploying standard and custom connectors, data collection rules, and custom Function Apps to build a tailored SIEM solution across hybrid and multi-cloud environments
- Develop and maintain KQL analytics rules, detection workbooks, and hunting queries to surface high-fidelity alerts and continuously improve mean time to detect (MTTD) across endpoint, identity, network, and cloud telemetry sources

- Parse, normalise, and optimise log telemetry from identity (Microsoft Entra ID), endpoint (CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint), network infrastructure, and cloud platforms to ensure detection precision and control data ingestion costs
- Partner with the incident response (IR) team on live security events, tuning analytics rules against real-world threat actor activity and updating SOAR playbooks to reflect lessons learned from each engagement
- Administer Microsoft Defender XDR (Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, Defender for M365) across an 8,000-user environment, integrating XDR signal feeds into Microsoft Sentinel for unified threat visibility and correlated detection
- Build and maintain SOAR playbooks using Azure Logic Apps to automate alert enrichment, triage routing, and containment response, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) across the security operations function
- Sync detection capability development with threat intelligence inputs, authoring new KQL analytics rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK adversary techniques and evaluating coverage gaps on an ongoing basis
- Administer CrowdStrike Falcon (NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover) and integrate Falcon telemetry into Microsoft Sentinel via custom connectors and ingestion pipelines for unified SIEM visibility
- Develop PowerShell and Azure CLI automation scripts to streamline SIEM alert correlation, parser maintenance, and investigation workflows

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Built and maintained Microsoft Sentinel analytics rules and KQL hunting queries, progressively maturing the organisation's SIEM content development capability and expanding MITRE ATT&CK detection coverage
- Managed log ingestion pipelines from diverse sources including Microsoft 365 (M365), CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Mimecast, and network infrastructure, ensuring telemetry completeness, parser accuracy, and cost-effective data ingestion
- Supported deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across 8,000 users, feeding high-quality endpoint and identity signals into Microsoft Sentinel for correlated detection
- Delivered Level 2/3 Security Operations Centre (SOC) triage and investigation within Microsoft Sentinel, handling complex escalations and contributing to post-incident reviews and rule-tuning sessions
- Developed PowerShell and KQL automation scripts to streamline SIEM alert correlation, enrichment, and reporting processes, reducing analyst workload on routine investigations
- Conducted proactive threat hunts using Microsoft Sentinel workbooks and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, identifying previously undetected intrusion attempts and translating findings into new analytics rules
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) including Conditional Access policies, MFA rollout, and SSO configuration, and fed identity telemetry into Sentinel for access anomaly detection
- Contributed to SOAR playbook development using Azure Logic Apps, automating alert enrichment and initial triage steps to improve analyst efficiency

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Supported implementation of centralised log management and security monitoring within a SaaS/FinTech hybrid cloud environment, contributing to log ingestion pipeline design and parser development
- Administered identity security controls using Azure Active Directory, including Conditional Access policies and MFA rollout across the organisation
- Managed endpoint protection and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) policies, monitoring alerts and escalating threats through the incident response workflow
- Developed PowerShell automation scripts to support security operations, configuration management, and reporting processes
- Conducted vulnerability assessments and produced actionable remediation guidance aligned to risk-based prioritisation principles

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and maintained enterprise-wide log ingestion into Microsoft Sentinel across a hybrid environment of 8,000+ users, including custom connectors and parsers for identity, endpoint, network, and SaaS telemetry sources, improving detection coverage and reducing data ingestion costs
- Authored over 40 KQL analytics rules in Microsoft Sentinel aligned to MITRE ATT&CK adversary techniques, expanding detection coverage across endpoint, identity, cloud, and network layers and reducing false positive rates
- Delivered Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) deployment across 8,000 users, integrating XDR signal feeds into Microsoft Sentinel to enable correlated, high-fidelity detection and significantly improving MTTD
- Developed SOAR automation playbooks using Azure Logic Apps that automated alert enrichment, triage routing, and initial containment steps, measurably reducing MTTR for the security operations team
- Led proactive threat hunt campaigns based on threat intelligence and MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, identifying previously undetected adversary activity and translating findings into new Sentinel analytics rules
- Operationalised CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM alongside Microsoft Sentinel, creating unified cross-platform detection and investigation capability across the enterprise estate

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc.** Environmental and Resource Engineering
- **B.Sc.** Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)